Quick Start Guide



Basic Rules

Roles

Danmaku!! is a hidden role game. Before the game begins, each player is dealt a role card that only they know. That player's victory condition is written on their role card.

There are four categories of role cards: **Heroine** (yellow), **Partner** (green), **Stage Boss** (red), and an **Extra Boss** (blue). Victory conditions involve defeating one or more other players based on these categories.



At the start of the game, the player who has the **Heroine** role reveals their role card. Everyone else keeps their role secret — for now.

Players need to determine who's on their team and who's just pretending based on their actions. However, an ally for one turn could turn into an enemy the next, so stay on guard!

Attacking and avoiding

Defeat players by playing cards that let you **attack** them. However, attacked players have a chance to play cards that let them **avoid** the attack. Avoided attacks don't hit or deal damage.

If the attack isn't avoided, that player is hit and takes damage, losing that much **life**.

Most attacks deal 1 damage.

Distance and range

Many cards tell you to choose a player **"in range."** A player is in range for you if your **range** is greater than or equal to the **distance** from you to that player.

Distance is measured from one person to another. Players sit in a circle to determine play order, but also to count the distance from one player to another. A player sitting next to you in either direction has a distance of 1. The player sitting next to them has a distance of 2, and so on.

Each player has a range value that starts at 1. Some cards like **Power** can increase your range, allowing you to choose and attack players seated further away.

Some cards like **Focus** can increase your distance as well. After counting the number of seats to a player, apply any distance modifiers on that player to find the total distance to that player. Only count distance bonuses on the person you're counting to, not on the attacker or any player seated in between!

Characters

Each player has a character. The top box on a character card is that character's Ability. It's a passive effect that only that character gets.

The lower box on the character card is that character's 🂠Spell Card. These are one-shot effects that are activated by playing a card like **Spiritual Attack** that says "**Activate your 🂠Spell Card.**" Some 🂠Spell Cards can only be activated under specific conditions listed in the 🂠Spell Card's text box.

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Card limits

Players have a limit on the number of certain kinds of cards they can control, play, or hold in hand.

Danmaku limit: By default, a player can only play one Danmaku card each turn.

Spell Card limit: By default, a player can only activate one Spell Card each round.

Defense limit: By default, a player can only control one Defense card at a time.

Artifact limit: By default, a player can only control one Artifact card at a time.

Exchange limit: By default, a player can only exchange once per turn.

Max hand size: By default, a player must discard down to 4 cards during each discard step.

Life, defeat and victory

By default, each player starts with 4 **life**. Whenever a player takes damage, they lose that much life.

Whenever a player loses life for any reason, they draw that many cards.

When a player's life is reduced to 0, they are **defeated** and reveal their role card.

Then, if any player has fulfilled the **victory condition** on their role card, they can reveal their role card and declare victory, ending the game.

Danmaku!! is a team game, so more than one player can declare victory at the same time.

Exchanging

Once per turn, a player may **exchange** to draw a main deck card by discarding 3 points worth of cards. The top-right number on cards is that card's point value. See ***Exchanging*** in the full rule book for more details.

Playing your first game

For your first game of *Danmaku!!* you can play with 4 to 7 players, though we recommend 5 or 6 players for a faster, balanced game. This game uses only the light blue **main deck** and no expansion decks.

1. Shuffle the main deck

Open the main deck (light blue cards) and pull out cards numbered 1–60. They have a ☯ yin-yang symbol in the bottom-left corner. Shuffle these cards to make the main deck. The other main deck cards aren't used this game and can be returned to the box.

2. Deal role cards

Set aside the basic role cards **Heroine**, **EX Boss**, **Stage Boss**, and **Partner**. Don't include the variant role cards such as **Final Boss**. Add role cards to a face-down pile according to the number of players:

No. of players:	4	5	6	7
Heroine	1	1	1	1
Partner	0	1	1	2
Stage Boss	2	2	3	3
EX Boss	1	1	1	1

Shuffle this pile and deal each player one face-down role card. They can look at the card, but don't reveal it.

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3. Deal character cards



Search the character deck for cards with a ☯ yin-yang symbol in the bottom-left corner. These are the recommended characters for your first game.

Shuffle this pile and deal each player two character cards. Each player chooses one to keep and discards the other. At the same time, all players reveal their character.

4. Reveal the Heroine

The **Heroine** reveals their role card. They will be the first player this game.

5. Deal starting hands

Starting with the Heroine, in turn order (clockwise), each player draws their starting hand. Players later in turn order get more cards:

Turn order:	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**
Starting hand size	5	4	4	5	5	6	6

Players may immediately put any number of **Item** cards from their hand into play. Then, each player discards down to their max hand size (4 by default).

Note: **Patchouli Knowledge** draws 3 additional cards in her starting hand and has +3 max hand size.

6. Start the game

The Heroine takes their first turn.

Steps in a turn

Draw step: The current player draws 2 cards.

Main step: The current player can play any number of Action cards and/or Item cards. The current player can exchange.

Exchange step: All players can exchange and/or play Item cards.

Discard step: All players must discard down to their max hand size.

See ***Phases of a Turn*** in the full rule book for the complete list of steps in a turn when using other decks.

Continue in turn order until a player declares victory!

Your next game

After your first game, consider adding the rest of the main deck, more characters, and additional decks. A good idea is playing your next game using the **incident** deck. See ***Game modes*** in the full rule book for additional ways to play the game.

